

The Pastoral Ecosystems and Valorization of Spontaneous Plants
 and Associated Microorganisms Laboratory
 (LR16IRA03) at the Arid Regions Institute of Medenine,
 organizes

The First International Seminar on
Rangelands and Pastoralism :
Reality and Challenges for
Sustainability



RanPasS1

Djerba, Tunisia, 2-5 April 2026

PROGRAM



BOOK OF ABSTRACTS



PROGRAM RANPASS1



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The First International Seminar on Rangelands and Pastoralism: Reality and Challenges for Sustainability (RanPasS1)

Djerba - Tunisia: April 2-5, 2026

<i>RanPasS1: The program</i>	
KS: Keynote Speaker, S: Speaker, P: Poster	
Day 0, Wednesday, April 01, 2026	
14:00	Organizers/Check-in
Day 1, Thursday, April 02, 2026	
08:00-9:00	Attendee Arrival/Registration/Check-in
9:00-11:30	Opening Session: Official Statements
	Program Introduction (LR16IRA03)
	Research & innovation in rangelands: the Tunisian case study (Prof. Mohamed Tarhouni)

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11:30-12:00		Coffee Break	
		<i>Topic 1: Ecological dynamics of arid rangelands: biodiversity, management techniques, ecosystem functioning, climate change impacts</i>	
		President: Prof. Igshaan Samuel	Rapporteurs : Farah Ben Salem ; Abderrazak Tlili
12:00-12:10	Editor In-Chief	Prof. Mohamed Ksibi	Brief presentation of Euro-Mediterranean Journal for Environmental Integration
12:10-13:00 (40 min+ 10 min)	KS-1	Prof. Azaiez Ouled Belgacem	Arid Rangeland Ecosystems Under Pressure: Biodiversity, Management Practices, and Climate Change Implications
13:00-13:15	KS	Prof. Meshal Abdullah Alharbi	KSA Experience on rangeland management and biodiversity conservation
13:15-13:30	S1	Manam Wafi Barani Saaed	Rangeland Condition in the Southern El-Jabal El-Akhdar Region, Libya

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13:30-13:45	S2	Jamila Msadek	Seasonal grazing: an appropriate management strategy to maintain arid mountain rangelands and ensure their sustainability
13:45-15:00	Lunch Break		
15:00-15:15	S3	Azaiez Ouled Belgacem	Enhancing Rangeland Resilience under Mediterranean Semi-Arid Conditions: The Ecological Role of <i>Sulla</i> species in Suppressing <i>Stipellula capensis</i>
15:15-15:30	S4	Rania Mechergui	Breaking Seed Dormancy and Environmental Stress Tolerance in <i>Calligonum azel</i> in arid Tunisian ecosystem
15:30-15:45	S5	Djamila Zammouri	<i>Ex-situ</i> conservation of Tunisian Flora in Arid and Desert Areas in a Changing Environment
15:45-16:00	S6	Mansour Secrafi	Resilience and Vulnerability of Key Pastoral Grasses Under Future Climate Scenarios: Implications for Arid Rangeland Sustainability
16:00-16:15	S7	Maher Mahmoudi	Ecological Plasticity and Drought Adaptation of <i>Polygonum equisetiforme</i> as a Functional Indicator of Climate Change in Tunisian Arid Rangelands



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16:15-16:30	S8	Nesrine Harboub	Harnessing <i>Salicornia</i> and <i>Sarcocornia</i> for Sustainable Development in Arid and Coastal Regions
16:30-16:45	S9	Zayneb Soilhi	Modeling Current and Future Distributions in Kerkennah islands of <i>Hyparrhenia hirta</i> and <i>Suaeda aegyptiaca</i> under Future Climate Change
	Posters session		
	P1	Ines Romdhane	Structural and Functional Degradation of Rested Communal Rangelands: the case of Dhahar Beni Khedache in Southern Tunisia
	P2	Amel Ennajah	Characterization of the Drought Stress Response of a Spontaneous Pasture Legume (<i>Cytisus villosus</i>) for Conservation Management
	P3	Oumaima Mahir	New Perspectives on Breeding and Feeding Systems of Sheep in the Beni Mathar Steppe, high plateaus of eastern Morocco



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Day 2, Friday, April 03, 2026			
<i>Topic 2</i> <i>Innovations for rangeland monitoring and sustainable management: technological innovative tools (GIS, RS, AI, Mobile apps, etc.), Ecological indicators, Pastoral plants, Micro-organisms</i>			
President: Mohamed Ouassar		Rapporteurs : Maher Gtari ; Imed Sbissi	
8:00-9:50 (40 min+ 10 min)	KS-2	Dr. Essifi Bouajila	A Machine Learning-Driven, Cloud-Based Framework for Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN) Assessment in Tunisia's Rangelands
9:50-10:05	S10	Fathia Jarray	Remote sensing-based assessment of land degradation and restoration in a semi-arid Mediterranean region
10:05-10:20	S11	Kaoutar Aboukhalid	Indicator species for degradation and their Seasonal Nutritive Role as Alternative Forage in Eastern Morocco

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10:20-10:35	S12	Minmin Yu	From Global Surveys to Local Decisions: A Flexible Framework for Rangeland Degradation Monitoring
10:35-10:50	S13	Abderrazak Tlili	Analysis of Land Degradation Under Different Grazing Regimes in semi-Arid TUNISIA: A 30-year NDVI Trend Study in Oueslatia
10:50-11:05	S14	Svetlana Lyashenko	Resource Potential, Biomass Production, and Ecological Significance of <i>Salsola iberica</i> in the Coastal Lowlands of Dagestan
11:05-11:30	Coffee Break/ Poster Session		
11:30-11:50	S15	Prof. Ciro Isidoro	Health Benefits from plants and micro-organisms
11:50-12:05	S16	Mustapha Ennajah	Plasticity in the xylem structure and function in two saltbush shrub species (<i>Atriplex</i>) from differing Mediterranean Type Climate microhabitats

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12:05-12:20	S17	Amal Ben Hmed	Aquaponics system: a sustainable, circular production approach
12:20-12:35	S18	Ichrak Essid	FT-IR Profiling Reveals Cultivation-Driven Cadmium-Chelating
11:05-11:30	Posters Session		
	P4	Hana Dali	<i>Frankia incanae</i> sp. nov., a new nitrogen-fixing and nodulating actinobacterium isolated from <i>Alnus incana</i>
	P5	Rihab Hamra	Phylogenomic reassessment of the family <i>Rhodanobacteraceae</i> resolves genus-level polyphyly and supports the proposal of eight novel genera
	P6	Kaoutar Aboukhalid	Characterization of Major Feed Resources Used in Sheep Production Systems in Eastern Morocco, Using Near-Infrared Spectroscopy (NIRS)

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	P7	Tesnim Bouzidi	Insights into the probiotic Potential and Genomic Features of <i>Streptomyces</i> sp. BMG 50.12 Isolated from Tunisian Desert Soil
	P8	Kaoutar Aboukhalid	Effect of season on the nutritional value of some pastoral species in Morocco
	P9	Roukaya Ben Gaied	Deciphering Quorum Sensing Dynamics in Legume Root Microbiomes: Effect on Symbiotic efficiency and Sustainable nitrogen fixation
	P10	Zaineb Hayder	Ecophysiological plasticity and salinity adaptation of <i>Sarcocornia alpini</i> under controlled conditions
	P11	Naima Bennour	<i>Ephedra alata</i> in Southern Tunisia: Traditional Uses and Nutritional Value as a Multifunctional Rangeland Resource
	P12	Naima Bennour	<i>Moringa oleifera</i> as a Multifunctional Resource for Sustainable Rangelands in Southern Tunisia

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	P13	Naima Chouikhi	Phytochemical Composition, Bioactive Compound Content, and Antioxidant Activity of <i>Argania spinosa</i> Leaves from Tunisia and Algeria
	P14	Fida Mzoughi	Exploring the Natural Extract of <i>Peganum harmala</i> for the Sustainable Management of the Date Palm Mite
	P15	Echrak Boubaker	Halophyte-Associated Bacteria as Promising Bio-inoculants for Salinity-Resilient Agriculture in Arid Regions
12:35-15:00	Lunch break		

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Topic 3 <i>Livestock, Agropastoralism, Agroecology and Ecosystem Services to optimize rangeland valorization</i>			
President: Raoudha Abdellaoui		Rapporteurs : Fayçal Boughalleb ; Hédi Mighri	
15:00-15:50 (40min+ 10 min)	KS-3	Prof. Igshaan Samuel	More than livestock: Arid rangelands as multifunctional landscapes for increased societal benefit
15:50-16:05	S19	Salma Sai Kachout	Impact of Intercropping on Weed Control, Soil Fertility, and Water Status in Tunisian Olive Orchards
16:05-16:20	S20	Ilyes Hadbaoui	Optimizing rangeland valorization through Sustainable Fencing Management in Algerian Steppes: Balancing livestock production and Ecosystem Services
16:20-16:35	S21	Jamila Msadek	Ecosystem services of arid mountain rangelands in southern Tunisia: implications for sustainable pastoral management

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16:35-16:50	S22	Hamza Bouras	Increase Biomass Production and Salinity Tolerance of Blue Panicum (<i>Panicum antidotale</i> Retz.) as an alternative forage in the Salt-Affected Soils of Arid Regions
16:50-17:05	S23	Meriem Zouaoui	Cypress Canker in the context of Agroecology
17:05-17:20	S24	Musa Usman Ndamba	Pastoralism and Agroecological Practices for Climate Action: Indigenous Solutions for Rangeland Restoration and Sustainable Food Systems in Cameroon
17:20-17:35	S25	Abdelmajid El Hamrouni	L'agro-sylvo-pastoralisme face aux effets du changement climatique et de l'anthropisation en Tunisie
17:35-17:50	S26	Oumayma Cheffi	Adaptation traits of local livestock breeds and the resilience of their production systems to climate change: the case of Siroua sheep, Drâa goats and Tidili cattle
17:50-18:05	S27	Aziza Zoghlami	Harnessing local genetic resources: developing improved forage legume varieties to withstand climate change and support livestock: From collection to release
18:05-18:20	S28	Mabrouk Seddik	Characterization of risk pastures contributing to the occurrence of Krafft's disease in dromedaries in southern Tunisia

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18:20-18:35	S29	Mandeep Singh Azad	Counting the Uncounted: Stastical Evidence on Livestock Healthcare and Veterinary Services among Migratory Tribes
18:35-18:50	S30	Michael Adedotun Oke	Challenges and Opportunities in Abattoir Operations: A Case Study from Gwagwalada, Abuja, Nigeria
	Posters Session		
	P16	Hajer Eljeni	Mineral and Phytochemical Characterization of Annual Plants from Southern Tunisia as Sustainable Livestock Feed
	P17	Samah Maaloul	Forage potential and nutritional characterization of <i>Silybum marianum</i> and <i>Silybum eburneum</i> organs in Tunisian rangeland ecosystems

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	P18	Ahlem Atoui	Pastoral Farming Systems in Arid Regions: Typology of Small Ruminant Farms in Southern Tunisia
	P19	Meriem Imelhayene	Camels in Ecological Interactions and the Enhancement of Ecosystem Resilience in Rangelands
	P20	Asma Cherif	Arid Rangeland Flora as a Source of Sustainable Botanical Pesticides for Date Palms
	P21	Tahar Tlig	Phytotoxic potential of <i>Eucalyptus globulus</i> Labill. leaves and litter against weeds growing spontaneously from the soil seed bank
	P22	Habib Lamourou	Stability and maturity indexes for the organic fraction in compost

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Day 3, Saturday, April 04, 2026			
Topics 4 + 5 <i>Local knowledge and pastoral communities practices: Traditional practices versus modern systems/managements, local resilience, pastoral mobility, community governance</i> + <i>Integrated approaches and multi-stakeholder partnerships: the role of research, women and young peoples in pastoral management, NGOs, governments and international institutions</i>			
President : Mohamed Jaouad		Rapporteurs : Mondher Fetoui ; Aziza Zoghlami	
8:00-8:50 (40 min+ 10 min)	KS-4	Prof. Aymen Frija	Beyond Rangelands: Integrating Traditional Knowledge and Territorial Intelligence for Resilient Pastoral Governance in South Tunisia

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8:50-9:05	S31	Mabrouk Laâbar	The rise and fall of pastoral commons: insights from Southern Tunisia
9:05-9:20	S32	Sinoyolo Kokwe	Ecological dependencies and socio-economic contributions linked to pastoralism in southern Africa
9:20-9:35	S33	Michael Adedotun Oke	Economic Behavior and Livestock Production in the Forestry Zones of Abuja: A Socio-Ecological and Technical Analysis
9:35-9:50	S34	Ceren Kazancı Oruç	Braided Resilience: The Keystone Role of Oaks and Conifers in Sustaining the Sarıkeçili Social-Ecological Continuum
9:50-10:05	S35	Mustapha Ibnelbachyr	Role of farmers' practices in the management of local livestock breeds on rangelands and their resilience to climate change: the case of Siroua sheep and Tidili cattle
10:05-10:20	S36	Clement Cupido	Integrating different knowledge systems to achieve resilience on pastoral commons in the drylands of South Africa
10:20-10:35	S37	Fatih Tatari	Governing Pastures: Commoning, Mobility, and Co-Creation in Northeastern Turkey
10:35-10:50	S38	Michael Adedotun Oke	Transforming Pastoral Mindsets: Reconciling Traditional Grazing Beliefs with Sustainable Land Governance in Abuja, Nigeria

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10:50-11:05	S39	Chrifa ELjerou	Valorisation des bio-ressources végétales et économie circulaire en zones arides tunisiennes : rôle stratégique de l'accompagnement technique
11:05-11:30	Coffee Break		
11:30-11:45	S40	Nasr Raggad	Individual Grazing Strategies and the Commons Dilemma: Evidence from Collective Rangelands in Southern Tunisia
11:45-12:00	S41	Tilen Ochieng Ododa	Digital Stewardship for Sustainable Rangelands: Leveraging AfriScout to Support Pastoralist Decision-Making in East Africa
12:00-12:15	S42	Aicha Laroussi	Typology of Pastoral Farming Systems in Arid Ecosystems: The Role of Labor Handling and Management Strategies in the Tataouine Governorate (Southern Tunisia)
12:15-12:30	S43	Michael Adedotun Oke	Navigating the Crisis: A Resilience-Based Framework for Sustainable Rangeland Management and Pastoralist Security in Nigeria
12:30-12:45	S44	Susan Achayo	Empowering the Custodians: The Vital Role of Women and Youth in Sustainable Rangeland Management

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Discussion & Outcomes
Lunch + Check out
Free Afternoon for attendees participating in field trip
Day 4, Sunday, April 05, 2026
Field Trip: Departure at 7:00 am from the hotel

